```
$str = <<< 'TNG'
Captain's log, {${getVarName()}}. The Enterprise remains concealed in the
dust cloud. And, to my surprise, the {$obj->getEnemy()} have maintained
their position waiting for us to come out of hiding. I have no explanation
for their special interest in me or this ship.
TNG;
```

```
Output:
Captain's log, {${getVarName()}}. The Enterprise remains concealed in the
dust cloud. And, to my surprise, the {$obj->getEnemy()} have maintained
their position waiting for us to come out of hiding. I have no explanation
for their special interest in me or this ship.
```

"Binary" Strings

The final form of language construct for creating string data is something of an historical oddity. Throughout this book, we have seen older versions of PHP mentioned, versions 7, 5, and earlier. The astute amongst you might have noticed the lack of PHP 6: this is because PHP never had an official version 6 release, although one was certainly planned and worked on. The principle reason that version 6 was abandoned is directly related to the material in this chapter: the handling of text data. PHP 6 was intended to revolutionize how string data was treated internally by PHP: all strings were to be Unicode, and PHP 6 was going to have "native Unicode support." The precise nature of Unicode is explored in detail in the next section of this chapter, but in a nutshell, it meant a fundamental change in what strings were.

Up to PHP 5, strings were simply a sequence of bytes with no special meaning. PHP 6 was going to differentiate between a byte sequence and a string of characters because of the growing use of multi-byte characters in text data. PHP is a language invented for the web, and the web was adopting multi-byte character encoding at a rapid pace; the idea was that PHP should naturally support this with as little friction as possible. In anticipation of this differentiation between strings-as-byte-sequences and strings-as-character-sequences, PHP 5.2 introduced the binary string syntax `b'this is a binary string';` that would indicate that the data was not to be treated as Unicode text and retain the default string handling features of PHP <= 5.x.